# Jeffery Kline, PhD

**Strategy and Analytics Leadership · Planning, Decision Systems, Applied AI**

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## PROFILE

Strategy and analytics leader with a UW–Madison mathematics PhD and 15+ years turning complex operational and behavioral data into decisions leaders act on, across physics research (LIGO), adtech, insurtech, and fintech. Built and led Affirm's servicing planning function; founding scientist at a measurement startup through its acquisition.

## STRENGTHS

**Strategy:** framing decisions; multi-year planning; prioritization under uncertainty; cost and service tradeoffs.
**Leadership:** building teams from zero; restructuring roles; aligning product, engineering, finance, and operations.
**Methods:** forecasting under uncertainty; optimization; measurement integrity; applied AI with verification; Python, SQL.

## EXPERIENCE

**Affirm** **2022–2026**
Risk and Growth Analytics · Staff → Manager San Francisco, CA (remote)

- Built an analytics team from zero; led cross-functional planning, owning multi-year staffing and infrastructure plans for a high-eight-figure servicing budget while operations expanded from two to four geographies.
- On taking ownership, lifted service-level attainment from 53% to 100% and held it for more than two years; reduced US cost per transaction by over 25%, with plans secured to bring the total reduction above 35%.
- Helped design and led several pivots in the vendor network and operations structure, meeting service levels and cost guardrails without operational disruption and keeping cross-functional delivery on schedule.
- Secured a 20% cost reduction in one operating market through restructuring; shifted about 25% of team capacity from reactive work to longer-term problems.
- Replaced an unscalable legacy forecasting system; introduced seasonal forecasting into company-wide peak-season capacity planning with executive and board visibility, contributing to eight-figure cumulative savings and stable engineering and operations through peak season.
- Moved the team from no agentic AI work to deep integration within six months; influenced adoption by adjacent teams.

**Neutronian** **2020–2024**
Senior Consultant (part-time) San Francisco, CA (remote)

- Advised the founders on algorithms, data architecture, and validation; shaped the data-privacy rating and certification methodology adopted in client onboarding.

**American Family Insurance** **2019–2022**
AI/ML Innovation and Research Lead Madison, WI (hybrid)

- Led applied AI research programs with UW–Madison in transformers, optimization, and knowledge graphs, publishing at ICML, ICLR, and NeurIPS and EMNLP workshops; co-initiated a First Street Foundation partnership and secured engineering support for its MVP.

**Hitwise** **2018–2019**
Principal Data Scientist Santa Monica, CA (remote)

- Hired by the CEO to retire the legacy pipeline and rebuild the flagship product on new data sources, a company priority.

**Comscore / MdotLabs** **2013–2018**
Principal Data Scientist; Founding Scientist Reston, VA and Madison, WI

- Founding scientist at MdotLabs through Comscore's 2014 acquisition; became Comscore's technical lead and methodology expert for ad fraud, investigating large-scale schemes such as a Google SafeFrame attack estimated at $5M per day.

**LIGO Scientific Collaboration** **2010–2013**
Postdoctoral Researcher Caltech/MIT; Milwaukee (hybrid)

- Built data replication for a federation of 96 universities, in service through the first gravitational-wave detection in 2015.

## RESEARCH AND EDUCATION

- **Publications:** nearly 30, including ICML, ICLR, and ACM IMC; *Linear Algebra and its Applications* (3), *Theoretical Computer Science*, *Discrete Applied Mathematics*, *Optimization Methods and Software*; and LIGO collaboration papers in *Physical Review D*. Full list at ORCID.
- **Patents:** one granted US patent and two published applications; one additional patent in progress at Affirm.
- **Independent research, 2026–present:** direct Claude and Codex from idea generation through adversarial audit, verification, and reproducible public release at jeff-kline.github.io.
- **PhD, Mathematics** (convex optimization), University of Wisconsin–Madison, 2010.